

Mapping With Melanin™ — Three-Layer Tag Architecture

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Version: 1.0

Governs: MWM_ENDORSEMENT_TAG_SYSTEM.md v1.0 and
MWM_THE_REAL_Professional_Trust_System.md v1.0

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1. Why three layers

A single flat list of tags cannot serve both a soul food restaurant and a family law attorney. The question a user brings to each is fundamentally different, and flattening those questions into one panel makes the app feel generic in exactly the categories where it should feel indispensable.

The architecture therefore separates the community's knowledge into three layers, each answering a different question:

Layer	Question	Example tag	What it is not
THE VIBE	What kind of visit is this?	Date Night, Hood Classic, Cookout Approved	Not a quality judgment
THE REAL	Can I trust this person with something that matters?	Believed Me, Fought For Me, No Predatory Terms	Not atmosphere, not politeness
ONE-TAP ENDORSEMENTS	Was this good?	Grandma Approved, Portions With Love, Fair Price	Not a rating, not a review

The governing insight is that **atmosphere and trust are never both the primary question**. A user choosing a restaurant wants to know whether the food is good and what kind of night it will be. A user choosing an OBGYN wants to know whether she will be believed. Nobody has ever needed both answers about the same business, which is why Layers 1 and 2 are mutually exclusive while Layer 3 is universal.

2. The complete routing table

Every one of the 22 categories resolves to exactly one of `vibe` , `real` , or `none` , stored in the `tag_layer_routing` table rather than hardcoded. Layer 3 endorsements are present everywhere and are therefore not a routing decision.

#	Category	Layer	Layer tags	Endorsements
1	Food & Drink	The Vibe	8	Yes
2	Beauty & Personal Care	none	—	Yes
3	Health & Wellness	The Real (subcategory split)	19	Yes
4	Shopping & Retail	none	—	Yes
5	Travel & Hospitality	The Vibe	8	Yes
6	Arts, Culture & Entertainment	The Vibe	8	Yes
7	Professional Services	The Real	15	Yes
8	Home & Property Services	The Real	14	Yes
9	Automotive & Transportation	The Real	14	Yes
10	Events & Celebrations	The Vibe (venues only)	8	Yes
11	Education & Learning	none	—	Yes
12	Children & Family	The Vibe	8	Yes
13	Community & Nonprofit	none	—	Yes
14	Faith & Spirituality	The Vibe (restrained set)	6	Yes
15	Media & Creative Services	none	—	Yes

16	Sports & Recreation	The Vibe	6	Yes
17	Pets & Animal Services	The Real	13	Yes
18	Technology & Digital Services	The Real	14	Yes
19	Financial & Business Services	The Real	15	Yes
20	Legal & Government Services	The Real	17	Yes
21	Agriculture & Specialty Producers	The Vibe (farmers markets only)	6	Yes
22	Other Services	The Real	13	Yes

Nine categories receive THE REAL, eight receive THE VIBE, and five receive neither. All 22 receive endorsements.

2.1 The one subcategory-level exception

Health & Wellness is the only category where the layer is decided below the main-category level, because the category legitimately contains both clinical care and movement experiences.

Subcategory	Layer	Reasoning
Primary Care & Medical Practices	Real	Clinical trust
Dental	Real	Clinical trust
Mental Wellness & Therapy	Real	Clinical trust
Physical Therapy	Real	Clinical trust
Chiropractic	Real	Clinical trust
Nutrition & Dietitians	Real	Clinical trust
Wellness Centers	Real	Clinical trust

Doula & Birth Services	Real	Highest-stakes trust in the app
Holistic Wellness	Real	Clinical trust
Pharmacies	Real	Clinical trust
Home Health & Caregiving	Real	Clinical trust, in the home
Fitness & Gyms	Vibe	The question is what the room feels like
Personal Trainers	Vibe	Experience-driven
Yoga & Pilates	Vibe	Experience-driven

Note that the three vibe subcategories still carry the endorsement tag `health_no_judgment_body` ("No Judgment About My Body"), which lives in Layer 3 and therefore renders regardless of layer routing. That tag matters enormously in fitness spaces, and the routing decision must not accidentally suppress it.

3. How the layers compose on a business profile

3.1 An experience business — soul food restaurant

Plain Text

Sylvia's Kitchen
Soul Food · Black-Owned · Open until 10pm

WHAT STANDS OUT

[101 said Grandma Approved] ← pinned
[64 said Seasoned Right] ← pinned
[41 said Portions With Love] ← pinned
[22 said Worth The Drive]

THE VIBE (collapsed)
(37 said Family Reunion Energy)
(18 said Hood Classic)

Endorsements lead because the first question about a restaurant is whether the food is good. The Vibe sits below in outlined chips, collapsed by default.

3.2 A professional business — OBGYN practice

Plain Text

Dr. Amara Bello, OBGYN Primary Care · Black-Owned · Accepts Medicaid

THE REAL What the community knows that Google doesn't. [247 said: This Doctor Listens] ← pinned [198 said: Believed My Pain] ← pinned [84 said: Respected My Birth Plan] ←pinned [52 said: Culturally Competent Care] [31 said: Staff Looked Like Me]

WHAT STANDS OUT [156 said Didn't Rush Me] [98 said Front Desk Was Kind] [44 said Grandma Trusts Them]
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Something wasn't right? Tell us privately.
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THE REAL leads because the first question about a doctor is whether she will be believed. The private-report footer is mandatory on every professional profile.

3.3 A neither-layer business — bookstore

Plain Text

The Reading Room Books & Bookstores · Black-Owned
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WHAT STANDS OUT [88 said Shelves Reflect Us] ← pinned [54 said No Follow-Around] ← pinned [39 said Owner Remembers Me] ← pinned
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One section only. This is correct and complete for five of the 22 categories.

4. The rules table

These rules are the complete rendering and behavior contract across all three layers.

#	Rule	Vibe	Real	Endorsements
1	Earned by community tap, never self-assigned	Yes	Yes	Yes
2	10-tap public display threshold	Yes	Yes	Yes
3	One user, one tap, per tag, per business	Yes	Yes	Yes
4	Candidate set driven by category, never by user identity	Yes	Yes	Yes
5	Praise-only; no negative or corrective tag exists	Yes	Yes	Yes
6	Cultural variants resolve from saved language preference only	Yes	Yes	Yes
7	Renders on every category	No (8)	No (9)	Yes (22)
8	Mutually exclusive with the other layer tag section	Yes	Yes	N/A
9	Position on profile	Below endorsements	Above endorsements	Middle
10	Chip style	Outlined	Filled with accent border	Filled
11	Collapsed by default	Yes	No	No
12	Display string	{count} said {label}	{count} said: {label}	{count} said {label}

13	Localized section header	Not yet	Yes, 11 communities	Not yet
14	Ordering signal	<code>sort_weight</code>	<code>trust_weight</code> then count	count then <code>sort_weight</code>
15	Elevated anti-gaming controls on flagged tags	No	Yes, <code>is_high_stakes</code>	Safety tags only
16	Private-report footer required in panel	No	Yes	No
17	Never derived from police, arrest, or census income data	Yes	Yes	Yes
18	Owner may view counts but never edit	Yes	Yes	Yes
19	Accumulates on <code>live_unclaimed</code> pins before any owner claims	Yes	Yes	Yes

4.1 The three rules that are absolute

Three rules cut across every layer and must never be traded away for a product improvement, a growth experiment, or a partner request.

The One-Way Mirror Rule. The only input to cultural variant resolution is `users.community_language`, set by the user in Settings. Never device locale as ethnicity, never name, never photo, never neighborhood, never browsing history, never a model inference. The app must never tell a user that anything was shown to them because of who they are. Kinfolk references behavior — "since you've been browsing salons" — never identity. Businesses see aggregate demographic demand; users never learn they were counted in it.

Praise-only. No layer contains a negative tag, a downvote, or a warning label. Negative experience routes to the private feedback and safety report flow, which never becomes a public counter and never adjusts a public badge. Absence of a badge is itself information, and a community fluent in reading absence will read it correctly.

No criminalizing data. Safety and welcome language across all three layers is community-reported lived experience only. It is never computed from, joined against, or displayed alongside police, arrest, traffic-stop, crime, or census income data. Neighborhoods are described as **welcoming**, never as "safe" in the crime-statistic sense.

4.2 Values rules that constrain the tag system

Two additional platform commitments interact directly with tag rendering and must be respected in any ranking or surfacing logic built on top of these layers. Community entrepreneurs always list for free, so tag eligibility can never depend on a paid tier. And non-minority-owned businesses are never promoted above minority-owned alternatives, which means tag counts alone must never be allowed to override ownership-designation ordering in search or map results.

5. Implementation quick reference

Need	Source of truth
Which layer does this business render?	<code>tag_layer_routing</code> , resolved subcategory-first then category, defaulting to <code>none</code>
What are the candidate tags?	<code>endorsement_tags</code> filtered by <code>category_ids</code> and <code>subcategory_keys</code> only
What label does this user see?	<code>endorsement_tag_variants</code> keyed on <code>users.community_language</code> , falling back to default
What does the section header say?	<code>section_header_variants</code> for <code>section_key='the_real'</code>
Has this tag gone public?	<code>business_endorsement_counts.count >= 10</code>
Which tags need tighter fraud controls?	<code>endorsement_tags.is_high_stakes = TRUE</code> (14 tags)
What order do Real tags appear in?	<code>trust_weight</code> DESC, then <code>count</code> DESC

The `VIBE_ENABLED_CATEGORIES` constant from the original endorsement spec is **deleted**. Two sources of truth for layer routing is a guaranteed future bug.

5.1 System totals after both specifications ship

Metric	Value
Main categories	22
Total tags in endorsement_tags	435 (340 existing, 39 reclassified in place, 95 new Real tags added)
Endorsement tags (Layer 3)	272
Vibe tags (Layer 1)	29
Real tags (Layer 2)	134
Adaptive tag families	16 (10 existing, 6 new)
Communities with label variants	11 plus secondary renderings
Display threshold	10 taps, all layers

Prepared by Manus AI for Mapping With Melanin™. Three layers, one truth, many voices.